

camcorders have an “audio zoom” feature that “zooms” in to pick up the audio from the direction in which the camcorder is pointed. A built-in windscreen on the microphone can help in cutting out the roar of the wind. Mid-range and high-end camcorders also support audio dubbing and CD-quality 12 and 16-bit PCM (Pulse Code Modulation) audio capture on two or more channels. If you’re planning on attaching professional audio recording equipment, the camcorder should have the required port, or at least be able to connect to an adapter that will in turn connect the audio equipment.

1.2.14 FireWire or USB?

Digital camcorders record and store the video (and audio) data in digital format. When it comes to transferring to a PC, it becomes important that the data is transmitted without any loss. This is where the FireWire interface comes in. FireWire, also known as IEEE 1394, provides a consistent transfer speed of 400 Mbps.



USB 2.0, on the other hand, claims to support a maximum throughput of 480 Mbps. This figure is slightly misleading, as the actual rate of transfer is controlled by the PC’s CPU, and USB 2.0 by itself cannot guarantee the transmission speed.

To transfer digital video, you need a transfer speed of around 3.6 megabytes per second. This is largely due to the nature of the digital video information. FireWire, at 400 Mbps, transfers data at around 50 MB per second. USB 2.0 can theoretically transfer data at around 60 MB per second, but unless both your PC and camcorder supports the USB Video Class 1 transfer standard, digital video over USB is transferred in VGA mode. Additionally, since